



Edima Essien

Full-Stack Product Designer

Multidisciplinary AI product designer with 7+ years bridging spatial, physical, and digital design.

With roots in architecture, BIM, and XR, I bring a systems-thinking approach to designing intelligent, human-centred AI experiences across immersive and conversational interfaces.

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Socials

LinkedIn
in/edima-essien

Medium
@edimaessien

Languages

English
Native

Italian
Professional

Soft Skills

- Systems thinker
- Visual communicator
- Cross-disciplinary
- AI-curious
- Detail-oriented
- Strategic
- Collaborative
- Adaptable
- Research-driven
- Storyteller
- Empathetic
- Self-directed

Latest projects



Smart City Decision Tool

Production React dashboard for AEC professionals to model how smart materials impact project performance — featuring data visualisation components, scenario comparison panels and real-time material inputs.

smart-city-decision-tool.web.app



Mentor Infrastructure Platform

Full Figma front-end for a mentorship app — all user flows, screen designs, component library and interactive prototypes covering onboarding, session booking, mentor–mentee matching and progress tracking.

mentor-infrastructure.web.app

Experience

Jun 2025 – Dec 2026 NJ, US · Remote



BIM Systems Designer & Product Manager
Youtopian

Current

Designed and shipped a full sports team management dashboard — giving coaches a centralised UI to track individual player health metrics, physical availability status, and performance data across the entire squad, with dynamic status indicators and filterable data views

Designed the complete front-end for the Mentor Infrastructure Platform — creating all user flows, screen designs, component library and interactive prototypes in Figma, covering onboarding, session booking, mentor–mentee matching and progress tracking

Built and shipped the Smart City Decision Tool — a production-ready React dashboard for AEC professionals to model how smart materials impact project performance, featuring data visualisation components, scenario comparison panels and real-time material property inputs

Defining BIM data standards, model protocols and system integration workflows across multi-disciplinary project teams, managing roadmap from user research through to engineering delivery

Jun 2022 – May 2025 NJ, US · Remote



Lead XR Architect
Youtopian

Designed and built complete UI systems for immersive VR — full spatial menus, diegetic UI panels, 3D HUD layers and interaction affordances — taking each project from concept through to shipped product

Engineered end-to-end XR interfaces in Unity, scripting interaction logic, building custom shaders and particle systems, and managing the full design-to-implementation pipeline for real-time AR/VR/MR environments

Produced all visual and motion design assets for XR — 3D icon libraries, transition animations, material systems and environment lighting — maintaining a reusable component system deployed across 4+ shipped products

Defined AI-informed interaction patterns for probabilistic and generative content within real-time environments, adapting UI layouts dynamically to model outputs

Nov 2021 – Mar 2022 Milan



Energy Modeler
GIV Ingegneria

Built parametric energy simulation models in Grasshopper & Rhino using Ladybug/Honeybee plugins, simulating thermal, HVAC and insulation performance for 20+ buildings under Italy's Superbonus 110% programme

Redesigned floor plans and envelope systems for 12 properties delivering layouts that achieved projected energy savings of 30–40% to meet Superbonus compliance criteria

Produced full technical documentation and visual reporting packages for client and regulatory sign-off, communicating complex simulation data through clear design narratives

Jun 2015 – May 2016 Austin



Architect I
Perkins + Will

Produced fully coordinated Revit BIM models for 3 commercial and educational projects, managing architectural, structural and MEP model integrity across disciplines

Designed and built physical presentation models at 1:50 and 1:100 scales, leading design development from schematic phase through to client-ready construction documents

Coordinated cross-disciplinary design reviews across architecture, engineering and contractor teams, translating technical constraints into actionable design decisions

Skills



AI Workflows

- Prompt-informed Prototyping
- AI-augmented Research
- LLM / Conversational UX
- Real-time AI Systems



UX / Design

- High-fidelity UI
- Motion & Interaction Design
- 3D / Spatial Design
- Dashboard Design
- Design Systems
- User Research
- Wireframing & Prototyping
- Web & Mobile Design



Development

- React JS
- JavaScript
- TypeScript
- Next JS
- HTML / CSS
- Framer



Technical

- Rhino / Grasshopper
- AutoCAD / Revit (BIM)
- Blender / Cinema 4D
- After Effects / Adobe CC
- Parametric Design
- 3D Printing / Laser Cutting



Leadership

- Product strategy & roadmap
- Cross-functional leadership
- Ideation to shipment
- Stakeholder storytelling
- Data-driven design

Tools

DESIGN & PROTOTYPING

- Figma
UI & proto
- ProtoPie
Prototyping
- Origami
Studio
- Framer
Web design
- Zeplin
Handoff
- Maze
Research

DEVELOPMENT

- React
Frontend
- JavaScript
Scripting
- TypeScript
Typed JS
- HTML5
Markup
- CSS3
Styling
- Next.js
Framework
- VS Code
Editor

3D, XR & ADOBE

- Unity
XR dev
- Blender
3D
- Cinema 4D
3D
- Rhino
Parametric
- After Effects
Motion
- Photoshop
Imaging
- Illustrator
Vector

BIM, CAD & PM

- Revit
BIM
- AutoCAD
CAD
- SketchUp
3D CAD
- Notion
PM
- Jira
PM
- Trello
PM

Education & certificates



Bachelor of Architecture
University of Texas at Austin
2010 – 2015



MSc Building Engineering
Politecnico di Milano
2018 – 2020

- LEED Building Design & Construction
U.S. Green Building Council · Sept 2015
- Business Foundations
University of Texas at Austin · May 2015
- Summer School — Workplace Management
Politecnico di Milano + Cornell · Summer 2019